



Introduction of data retention policies

Have you ever cleaned out your closet and donated some clothes to a charity?

Or maybe you've cleared out old pictures from your smartphone so your phone is faster and more efficient.

Now, what happens if you donate a sweater you actually meant to keep or deleted a photo that you really wish you still had?

Whatever type of cleaning you're doing, it's important to have a plan in place so you don't accidentally throw away something you need!

A clear process for cleaning, or for deleting items, makes it easier to keep track of everything.

In your role as a data analyst, you'll likely encounter something called a **data retention policy** at your organization.

This is a key part of data management, which deals with how and when data is saved or deleted.

Data retention is the collection, storage, and management of data.

Every organization that collects data should have a **policy for its retention.**

These retention policies may consider internal needs, industry regulations, and laws that apply to the particular business.

A data retention policy should clearly define the scope of the policy and the reason for saving information.

It also defines whose data may be collected, both internally and externally.

And, as applicable, the policy may list any laws and regulations the organization follows.

The policy provides a detailed description of the organization's data retention process.

For example, a schedule for saving and deleting data, rules for keeping data safe, and processes for destroying data.

It also includes guidelines for data breaches.

Other guidelines that may be a part of a data retention policy include the format of the

data, whether the organization archives or destroys data, and who has authority to make decisions about deletion.

Now that you have an idea of what goes into the data retention policy, let's review some of the regulations that may affect your data, depending on the industry you work in.

A business may need to adhere to the following regulations or standards.

It's important to call out: Our discussion in this course should not be considered legal advice.

If it's a publicly traded company in the United States, it must adhere to the Sarbanes-Oxley Act for data retention.

Sarbanes-Oxley requires organizations to maintain internal control systems that protect financial data of consumers.

A business that accepts credit card payments must have policies that follow the Payment Card Industry Data Security Standard (PCI DSS).

This standard requires organizations to build secure networks, protect cardholder data, and implement strong access control measures.

A business must also regularly monitor and test all of these elements.

Certain healthcare organizations in the United States are subject to the Health Insurance and Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA), or HIPPA.

HIPAA establishes requirements to protect an individual's identifiable health information.

And any organization that processes personal data of European Union citizens, even if the organization is based outside the European Union, must follow the General Data Protection Regulation, or GDPR.

GDPR requires that reasons for personal data collection must be transparent, and a business may only use data for the stated collection purpose.

GDPR also provides European Union citizens with certain rights and requires that businesses securely store personal data.

When using a cloud service like Google Cloud, a data professional will usually activate a Bucket Lock feature.

A data professional can use this as a tool to create a data retention policy for each storage bucket and define how long it will be retained.

Google Cloud's Bucket Lock also provides access to a detailed audit log, which gives users a clear picture of data requests and responses.

This helps a business maintain compliance with policies about WHO accesses data and when.

Finally, object lifecycle management is an automated way a data professional can manage a data retention policy.

In the cloud, an "object" is data stored in a cloud object storage service.

The cloud service provider stores the data in large chunks with associated metadata.

This management process enables a data professional to create parameters for object storage, to delete objects or DATA, or move it into different buckets.

With predefined parameters, automation makes it easy for the business to keep track of important information!

You can use the strategies in this video to make your data more organized and secure.

You'll keep what you need for as long as you need it.

And get rid of what you don't to keep processes moving efficiently for speedy data insights!